

Obojima Brewing for Pathfinder 2e

A Guide to Magical Ingredients, Brewing, and Harvesting

Introduction

The Obojima Brewing system is an alternate crafting system for Pathfinder 2e that allows characters to gather magical ingredients from the world, harvest exotic materials from slain creatures, and combine them into mysterious alchemical brews.

Unlike normal Pathfinder crafting, brewers rarely know exactly what they are creating. Instead, the magical properties of the ingredients determine the category and strength of the final product. Even experienced alchemists frequently discover surprising new concoctions.

The system is designed to complement—not replace—the existing Pathfinder crafting rules.

Ingredients

Brewing requires **three magical ingredients**.

Ingredients come in two forms:

- **Natural Ingredients** found throughout the world
- **Monster Ingredients** harvested from defeated creatures

Every ingredient has several properties:

- Item Level
- Gold Piece Value
- Description and flavour text
- Icon
- Three hidden brewing values:
 - Combat
 - Utility
 - Whimsy

These hidden values determine what type of product the ingredient is best suited for.

Players generally will not know these values. Learning which ingredients work well together is intended to become part of the campaign.

Harvesting Ingredients

After combat ends, the GM is presented with each defeated creature and may choose whether it yields:

- a Brewing Ingredient
- a Monster Part
- both
- neither

Generated ingredients have names based on the creature, for example:

- Wyvern Venom
- Eagle Sinew
- Owlbear Feather
- Basilisk Eye
- Troll Blood

The exact material is chosen randomly from an appropriate list.

Generated ingredients are automatically saved into the Obojima Ingredients collection for future use.

Harvesting Monster Parts

Monster Parts represent valuable crafting materials used with Pathfinder's normal Craft activity.

Examples include:

- Dragon Scale
- Troll Heart
- Chimera Horn
- Wyvern Talon

Monster Parts have:

- Item Level
- Bulk
- Gold Piece Value
- Description
- Appropriate icon

Unlike brewing ingredients, Monster Parts have no hidden brewing values.

Instead, they function as valuable raw materials for permanent item crafting.

Their value scales according to creature level.

Harvesting Skill Checks

Attempting to remove either an Ingredient or Monster Part requires care.

Whenever a player attempts to remove one from a defeated creature, they choose whether to roll:

- **Crafting**
- **Survival**

Success transfers the item to the character.

Failure destroys the harvested material.

This represents accidentally contaminating or ruining the specimen.

Brewing

Brewing requires:

- Three Ingredients
- A Crafting check
- Access to an Alchemist's Laboratory or Brewing Kit

The module checks whether the character possesses:

- Alchemical Crafting (Skill Feat)

- or the Alchemist class feature

Characters lacking formal training may still attempt brewing, but every result is reduced by one degree of success.

Critical Success → Success

Success → Failure

Failure → Critical Failure

Critical Failure remains Critical Failure.

Brewing Categories

Every ingredient contains three hidden values:

- Combat
- Utility
- Whimsy

The values from the three ingredients are added together.

Whichever category has the highest total determines what type of product is created.

Examples:

High Combat

→ Bombs
→ Poisons
→ Oils

High Utility

→ Potions
→ Elixirs
→ Foods
→ Oils

High Whimsy

→ Unique custom magical brews inspired by Obojima.

Product Selection

The brewing system does **not** map ingredient values directly to specific items.

Instead:

Hidden Ingredient Values

↓

Winning Category

↓

Product Level

↓

A deterministic product of that category and level.

This allows every Pathfinder consumable of an appropriate level to remain available regardless of the hidden ingredient values.

Brewing Results

Critical Success

The brew succeeds spectacularly.

The brewer receives:

- Two copies of the product.
 - A Formula describing how to recreate it.
-

Success

The brewer receives:

- One copy of the product.

- A Formula describing how to recreate it.
-

Failure

Something goes wrong.

A mysterious potion is still produced.

The potion is completely unidentified.

The brewer does not learn its recipe.

When consumed, the potion produces the expected magical effect but also carries an unpredictable side effect.

Critical Failure

Disaster strikes.

The resulting potion appears to be an ordinary unidentified magical potion.

In reality it contains unstable magical energies.

The potion has no beneficial effect.

Instead, the first creature to drink it triggers one of many dangerous magical mishaps ranging from curses and mutations to explosive magical backlash.

Only the GM knows the potion's true nature until it is consumed.

Formulae

Whenever brewing succeeds, the character automatically learns the recipe.

Formulae are lightweight inventory items that record:

- Product Name
- Ingredient One

- Ingredient Two
- Ingredient Three

This allows brewers to remember successful combinations discovered during play.

Item Identification

All failed brews are properly integrated with Pathfinder's native Identification system.

Players simply see:

Unidentified Consumable

Only the GM knows whether the item is:

- a successful potion awaiting identification,
 - a failed potion with side effects,
 - or a catastrophically unstable brew.
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Wealth

Ingredient values scale by Item Level.

Lower-level ingredients are common and inexpensive.

Higher-level ingredients become progressively rarer and more valuable.

Monster Parts similarly scale according to creature level and provide valuable crafting resources for permanent magical items.

Equipment Bonuses

Specialized equipment can improve both harvesting and brewing.

Examples include:

- Harvesting Knives
- Alchemical Satchels
- Trophy Hunter's Tools
- Masterwork Cauldrons
- Fey Alembics
- Portable Laboratories

Equipment may grant bonuses such as:

Harvesting

- Harvest Bonus
- Ingredient Harvest Bonus
- Monster Part Harvest Bonus
- Harvest Level Bonus
- Extra Ingredients
- Extra Monster Parts

Brewing

- Brewing Bonus
- Combat Brewing Bonus
- Utility Brewing Bonus
- Whimsy Brewing Bonus
- Extra Brewed Items

The module supports both built-in equipment and custom items created by the GM using Pathfinder 2e Rule Elements.

Design Philosophy

The Obojima Brewing system is intended to encourage experimentation rather than optimization.

Players are rewarded for:

- exploring dangerous locations,
- hunting unusual creatures,
- discovering rare ingredients,
- recording successful recipes,
- and occasionally surviving spectacular brewing disasters.

Over time, every campaign develops its own catalogue of famous recipes, prized ingredients, and legendary concoctions, making brewing feel like an organic part of the world rather than simply another Crafting activity.